

Les Modaux en Anglais

Modal Verbs — Fiche de grammaire

■ Définition :

Les modaux sont des auxiliaires invariables exprimant : attitude, possibilité, capacité, devoir ou conseil.

Forme toujours : Modal + BV (pas de -s, pas de -ing) | Négatif : Modal + not + BV

Les 5 familles de modaux

Chaque modal exprime une nuance précise selon le contexte

1 Possibilité / Potentialité

may 50% Possibilité à 50%

→ It may rain. / Zohra may come tonight. (il se peut qu'il pleuve)

might 30% Possibilité moins probable

→ It might rain. / Zohra might go to the zoo. (très potentiellement)

2 Capacité technique

can présent Capacité / possibilité techniques

→ I can drive my car to come to visit you.

could passé/cond. Capacité conditionnelle ou passée

→ I could visit you if I had more time. / I could do this.

3 Conseil

should direct Conseil simple et direct

→ You should do your exercise. (Tu devrais faire ton exercice)

shall indirect Conseil avec distance / indirect

→ You shall go out to play with your brothers.

ought to moral Conseil moral

→ You ought to learn this to get your exam.

4 Ordre / Obligation

must direct Ordre direct et personnel

→ You must come here tonight to see us.

have to loi/morale Obligation liée à la loi ou la morale

→ You have to be over 18 to drink this.

5 Conditionnel

would cond. Action soumise à une condition

→ I would come to your place, if you were here.

would cond. Conditionnel en contexte

→ Zohra would eat this, if she's like it.

× Forme négative — Modal + not + BV

can't Incapacité

→ I can't drive without my glasses.

shouldn't Conseil négatif

→ You shouldn't eat so much sugar.

may not Possib. niée

→ She may not come tonight.

couldn't Passé/cond.

→ I couldn't visit you last year.

mustn't Interdiction

→ You mustn't smoke here.

wouldn't Refus/cond.

→ He wouldn't come if you called him.

